

Chicago Tribune



★

\$4.00 | TUESDAY, APRIL 7, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Boutros defends handling of Midway Blitz

After a year in job, Chicago’s US attorney reflects on immigration operation, changeover in office

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

One year into his tenure as Chicago’s top federal law enforcement officer, U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros is defending his handling of Operation Midway Blitz cases and says a changeover of the old guard and influx of new prosecutors has

reinvigorated an office that aims to get back to bread-and-butter targets like violent crime, public corruption and fraud.

And with accusations front and center that President Donald Trump has used the Justice Department to go after political enemies, Boutros is adamant it hasn’t happened in Chicago.

“There is not a single case involving politics in our decision-making, full stop. Period,” Boutros said last week, jabbing a finger into the conference table adjacent to his fourth floor office. “And anyone who says otherwise is misstating reality, and anyone who says otherwise is an armchair expert who doesn’t know what they are talking about.”

Boutros made the comments as part of a lengthy interview with the Tribune and Sun-Times to mark his tumultuous first year at the helm,

which he described as an “invigorating” opportunity to turn around a storied office that had been stagnating in recent years.

“I’ve been super-focused identifying what have been issues, what have been the problems, dealing with either productivity or efficiency, with our numbers, with morale, and then addressing it,” Boutros said. “And so it’s been fantastic.”



U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Friday. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

See **BOUTROS** on Page A4



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Shake-up in Chicago basketball

Monday was a wild one for Chicago’s pro basketball teams. The WNBA’s Sky traded star forward Angel Reese, above, after two tumultuous seasons for a pair of future first-round draft picks. And the NBA’s Bulls cleaned house in the front office, firing executive VP Artūras Karnišovas and general manager Marc Eversley after a six-year tenure in which the team made the playoffs only once. **Chicago Sports**



This image shows the moon, with the near side (the hemisphere we see from Earth) visible at the top half of the disk. At the lower center is Orientale basin, a nearly 600-mile-wide crater that straddles the moon’s near and far sides. Everything below the crater is the far side. **NASA**

Artemis II smashes Apollo 13 record

Surpassing 248,655 miles sets mark for distance

By Richard Tribou
ORLANDO SENTINEL

On a day the four crew of Artemis II broke a record set by Apollo 13 for farthest distance from Earth ever flown by humans, they made a request that two new craters be named: one to honor their Orion

spacecraft named Integrity, and one the memory of commander Reid Wiseman’s late wife, Carroll.

The Orion spacecraft and its four passengers ventured into the moon’s gravitational influence Monday, and at 12:57 p.m. Eastern time, surpassed the 248,655 miles traveled by the 1970 flight by

Apollo 13’s Jim Lovell, Fred Haise and Jack Swigert.

The new record holders are Wiseman and fellow NASA astronauts Victor Glover and Christina Koch along with Canadian Space Agency astronaut Jeremy Hansen.

“As we surpass the furthest distance humans have ever trav-

See **ARTEMIS** on Page A8

Emptied office space scooped up, revamped

Downtown buildings vacated in pandemic given new amenities

By Brian J. Rogal
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago office buildings left partially empty and debt-ridden after the pandemic are being scooped up by new development teams and undergoing refurbishment. The spiffed-up properties mean employees who commute downtown — even just a couple of days a week — could find new workspace amenities like tenant lounges and rooftop terraces.

The new building owners watched downtown property values collapse over the past six years, and they’re buying office complexes at a fraction of the prices they sold for in the past. That’s allowing them to offer lower rents and frills that previous owners couldn’t afford.

“That’s the formula that seems to be working,” said California-based developer Andrew Brog, who bought his first Chicago office building in 2024. “Provide deals that are lower than the marketplace, improve the building and improve the tenant experience. Many of these distressed buildings have been zombies for a long time.”

Many feared downtown would be swamped by foreclosures after the pandemic as building owners struggled to fill spaces left behind by the shift to work-from-home. With fewer rent dollars coming in, some building owners were also finding it difficult to make payments on their commercial mortgages. But although some foreclosures are still likely, there’s no sign of a crisis, said Steven Ginsberg, a real estate attorney and partner with Ginsberg Jacobs LLC.

See **OFFICES** on Page A2

Iran rejects proposal for 45-day ceasefire

Iran on Monday rejected a 45-day ceasefire proposal and said it wants a permanent end to the war, while President Donald Trump appeared to widen his threat from civilian targets to the whole Islamic Republic and his ultimatum ticked closer. **Nation & World**

SUBSCRIPTION

Visit myaccount.chicagotribune.com or call 312-546-7900 to sign up for a subscription. To place an ad, visit placeanad.chicagotribune.com.

WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 40 L: 32 **WED.** H: 65 L: 55 **THU.** H: 66 L: 45
Complete details on Page A14

INDEX

Almanac A8
Arts & Living B7
Comics B10-11
Crossword B11
Editorials A5
Horoscope B10
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A8
Television B9

178th year No. 97
© Chicago Tribune

